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“I CAN PLAY A STRATEGIC ROLE WITHIN THE HOLDING COMPANY OF THE BANK”

Bandhan Bank Founder, MD & CEO Chandra Shekhar Ghosh on the leadership transition, his plans, and microfinance

BY **ANAND ADHIKARI** PHOTO BY **DEBAJYOTI CHAKRABORTY**

CHANDRA SHEKHAR GHOSH, the Founder, MD, and CEO of Bandhan Bank, was one of the fortunate few to secure a full-scale banking licence. The 64-year-old transformed what started out as a microfinance institution (MFI) into a bank, providing credit access

to the underserved and unbanked. However, Bandhan’s journey as a bank has seen asset quality and profitability challenges post-Covid and other disruptions. Ghosh, whose recent decision to step down has surprised many in the industry, exits office on July 9. In an exclusive

interview with *Business Today*, Ghosh discusses the microfinance models, his decision to retire, and his new role in the group. Edited excerpts:



You created a business model focussed on serving the unbanked and

underserved, a market often perceived as risky by banks. Should this model be regulated and treated differently?

When an industry is new, flexibility is crucial to provide services to the people. However, as the industry scales, it requires more control, compliance,